

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT
SOUTHERN DISTRICT OF NEW YORK

----- x

RONALD BALDWIN,

Plaintiff,

**COMPLAINT AND
JURY DEMAND**

-against-

Docket No.

CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER MARCELLO
SOLANO Shield #7497, POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOE
#1-2,

Defendants.

----- x

Plaintiff Ronald Baldwin, by his attorney Amy Robinson, of Stoll, Glickman & Bellina, LLP, for his Complaint alleges as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action in which Plaintiff seeks relief through 42 U.S.C. §§ 1983 and 1988 for the violation of his civil rights protected by the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments, in addition to violations of the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

2. The claim arises from a June 29, 2015 incident in which officers of the New York City Police Department (“NYPD”), acting under color of state law, intentionally and willfully subjected Plaintiff to, among other things, false arrest, false imprisonment, and malicious prosecution.

3. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (special, compensatory, and punitive) against defendants, as well as an award of costs and attorneys’ fees, and such other and further relief as the Court deems just and proper.

JURISDICTION & VENUE

4. This action arises under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution and under 42 U.S.C. §§ 1983 and 1988 and the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

5. The jurisdiction of this court is predicated upon 28 U.S.C. §§ 1331, 1343(a)(3) and (4), 1367(a) and the doctrine of pendent jurisdiction.

6. Venue is laid within the Southern District of New York in that Defendant City of New York is located within and a substantial part of the events giving rise to the claim occurred within the boundaries of the Southern District.

PARTIES

7. Plaintiff RONALD BALDWIN resided at all times here relevant in Bronx County, City and State of New York.

8. The City of New York (“CITY”) is a municipal corporation organized under the laws of the State of New York. At all times relevant hereto, defendant City, acting through the NYPD, was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, training, supervision, discipline and retention and conduct of all NYPD personnel. In addition, at all times here relevant, defendant City was responsible for enforcing the rules of the NYPD, and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws of the United States and the State of New York.

9. Police Officer MARCELLO SOLANO was at all times here relevant, a police officer of the NYPD, and as such was acting in the capacity of an agent, servant, and employee of the City of New York. On information and belief, Officer Solano was involved in the decision to arrest Plaintiff without probable cause. Upon information and belief, Officer Solano was under the

command of Patrol Bureau Bronx Precinct on the date of the incident and is sued in his individual capacity.

10. Police Officers JOHN DOE ##1-2, whose true names are currently unknown to Plaintiff, were, at all times here relevant, police officers of the NYPD, and as such were acting in the capacity of agents, servants, and employees of the City of New York. On information and belief, at all times relevant hereto, defendant officers were involved in the decision to arrest Plaintiff without probable cause or failed to intervene in the actions of their fellow officers when they observed them arresting Plaintiff without probable cause. Upon information and belief, defendant officers were under the command of the 44th Precinct on the date of the incident and are sued in their individual capacities.

11. At all times here mentioned Defendants were acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the City and State of New York.

NOTICE OF CLAIM

12. Within 90 days of the events giving rise to these claims, Plaintiff filed a written Notice of Claim with the New York City Office of the Comptroller. Over 30 days have elapsed since the filing of the Notice, and this matter has not been settled or otherwise disposed of.

FACTUAL ALLEGATIONS

13. On June 29, 2015, at approximately 2:30 A.M., Plaintiff Ronald Baldwin was lawfully standing on the sidewalk in front of 1521 Sheridan Avenue in the Bronx, speaking with a friend.

14. Mr. Baldwin was not committing any crime and had not violated any laws.

15. All of a sudden, NYPD officers pulled up in a police van in front of 1521 Sheridan Avenue.

16. Three officers – Officers Solano and John Does ##1-2 – got out of the van, approached Mr. Baldwin and his friend, and accused them of being loud. The two men denied the allegation.

17. The officers asked for Plaintiff's identification. Plaintiff complied.

18. Officer Solano placed Plaintiff in handcuffs, claiming there was a United States Marshals warrant for his arrest. Plaintiff explained repeatedly that the warrant was not for him.

19. Without any further investigation or probable cause, Plaintiff was taken to the 44th Precinct.

20. When they arrived at the precinct, one of the defendant officers asked Mr. Baldwin to turn his head to the side. The officer remarked that Plaintiff, unlike the person who was wanted by the U.S. Marshals, did *not* have a neck tattoo.

21. Despite the obvious dissimilarity between Plaintiff and the wanted individual, the officers continued to hold Plaintiff without justification. Although Mr. Baldwin continued to insist that he was *not* wanted, the officers did nothing to verify that they had detained the correct person.

22. Several hours later, an officer handed Mr. Baldwin a summons for Disorderly Conduct, an offense he had not committed.

23. U.S. Marshals never arrived to pick up Mr. Baldwin. More than 10 hours after his false arrest, Mr. Baldwin was released from the precinct.

24. As Mr. Baldwin was released, an NYPD officer informed him that the person who was wanted was already in custody.

25. On August 18, 2015, Mr. Baldwin went to court to answer the summons. The case was dismissed and sealed.

26. At all times during the events described above, the defendant police officers were

engaged in a joint venture and formed an agreement to violate Plaintiff's rights. The individual officers assisted each other in performing the various actions described and lent their physical presence and support and the authority of their office to each other during said events. They failed to intervene in the obviously illegal actions of their fellow officers against Plaintiff.

27. During all of the events above described, defendants acted maliciously and with intent to injure Plaintiff.

DAMAGES

28. As a direct and proximate result of the acts of defendants, Plaintiff suffered the following injuries and damages:

- a. Violation of his rights pursuant to the Fourth Amendment of the United States Constitution to be free from an unreasonable search and seizure of their persons;
- b. Violation of his rights pursuant to the Fourteenth Amendment of the United States Constitution to due process;
- c. Violation of his New York State Constitutional rights under Article 1, Section 12 to be free from an unreasonable search and seizure;
- d. Violation of his New York State Constitutional rights under Article 1, Section 6 to due process;
- e. Emotional trauma and suffering, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, emotional distress, frustration, extreme inconvenience, anxiety; and
- f. Loss of liberty.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

42 U.S.C. § 1983

FALSE ARREST & MALICIOUS PROSECUTION

29. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference.

30. The officer defendants wrongfully and illegally arrested, detained and imprisoned, and

maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff, and failed to intervene in each other's obviously illegal actions.

31. The wrongful, unjustifiable, and unlawful apprehension, arrest, detention, and imprisonment of Plaintiff was carried out without a valid warrant, without Plaintiff's consent, and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion.

32. At all relevant times, Defendants acted forcibly in apprehending, arresting, and imprisoning Plaintiff.

33. All of this occurred without any illegal conduct by Plaintiff.

34. The summons was dismissed and sealed on August 18, 2015.

35. The officer defendants acted under pretense and color of state law and in their individual and official capacities and within the scope of their respective employment as NYPD officers. Said acts by officer defendants were beyond the scope of their jurisdiction, without authority of law, and in abuse of their powers, and said defendants acted willfully, knowingly and with the specific intent to deprive Plaintiff of his constitutional rights secured by the United States Constitution.

36. As a direct and proximate result of the misconduct and the abuse of authority detailed above, Plaintiff sustained the damages described above.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

42 U.S.C. §1983

MUNICIPAL LIABILITY

37. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference.

38. The City is liable for the damages suffered by Plaintiff because, after learning of its employees' violations of New Yorkers' constitutional rights, the City has: failed to remedy the wrong; created policies or customs under which unconstitutional practices regularly occur and

even thrive; and has been grossly negligent in managing subordinates who cause the unlawful events. The result of the City's inaction is a culture within the NYPD where the same officers, the same units, and the same precincts repeatedly and routinely engage in acts of misconduct. By failing to properly train, supervise, and discipline its employees, agents, and servants, the City effectively encourages illegal, immoral, and unprofessional behavior.

39. The City has been aware for some time – from civil rights lawsuits, Notices of Claim, complaints filed with the Civilian Complaint Review Board (“CCRB”), City Council hearings, newspaper reports, criminal cases resulting in declined prosecutions and dismissals, and judicial rulings suppressing evidence and finding officers incredible as a matter of law – that a disturbing number of NYPD officers unlawfully search and seize New Yorkers without probable cause, bring charges against New Yorkers with no legal basis, perjure themselves in charging instruments and through testimony, and fail to intervene in and report the obviously illegal actions of their fellow officers.

40. Despite having acquired such knowledge, the City has refused to appropriately sanction its employees' illegal behavior.

41. The City's deliberate indifference to civil rights violations committed by individual police officers, as well as patterns of misconduct committed by the same officers or occurring in the same precinct has caused the constitutional violations against Plaintiff in this case.

THE CITY FAILS TO TRACK CIVIL RIGHTS LAWSUITS, THEREBY SEVERING ANY POTENTIAL DETERRENT VALUE

42. For decades, the City has been on notice that certain officers and precincts are disproportionately responsible for civil rights lawsuit liability. Nonetheless, the City has failed to take action to hold officers or precincts accountable.

43. In 1999, Comptroller Alan Hevesi, in a memo to Police Commissioner Howard Safir,

stated that there was “a total disconnect” between the settlements of civil claims – even substantial ones – and NYPD discipline of officers.¹ Hevesi continued:

As a result, the NYPD does not learn of potential problem officers, fails to take curative action, and not infrequently fosters a situation in which an officer will engage in another act of violation, resulting in harm to another person and further damages from the City. More important, study of a large number of cases might well reveal patterns of misconduct against which the NYPD could and should take systematic management action.²

44. The Comptroller recommended that the police department “analyze . . . settled claims, and take steps to review the officers’ performance and propensity to commit acts of excessive force.”³

45. The City has not heeded Hevesi’s advice, and the “total disconnect” remains fully in place today. The number of claims against the NYPD has doubled in recent years, costing taxpayers more than \$1 billion.⁴

46. Yet the City continues to resist attempts to catalog even the most basic information

¹ *Id.*

² *Id.*

³ *Id.*

⁴ See Barry Paddock, Rocco Parascandola, John Marzulli, & Dareh Gregorian, *Exclusive: Detective is NYPD’s most-sued cop, with 28 lawsuits filed against him since 2006*, N.Y. DAILY NEWS, Feb. 16, 2014, <http://www.nydailynews.com/new-york/lawsuits-nypd-double-decade-costing-taxpayers-1b-article-1.1615919#ixzz2ttDX4ZkE> (reporting that the number of claims against the NYPD doubled between 2004-2014, to a record high of 9,570 lawsuits filed in 2012, costing taxpayers nearly \$1 billion); Colleen Long & Jennifer Peltz, Associated Press, *Nearly \$1B in NYC police payouts*, Yahoo! News (October 14, 2010, 7:44 PM), <http://news.yahoo.com/ap-investigation-nearly-1b-nyc-police-payouts.html> (reporting that, in the decade ending in 2010, the City paid out nearly one billion dollars to resolve claims against the NYPD); Caroline Bankoff, *The City Has Paid Almost Half a Billion Dollars in NYPD-Related Settlements Over the Past 5 Years*, NYMag.com, Oct. 12, 2014, <http://nymag.com/daily/intelligencer/2014/10/428-million-in-nypd-related-settlements-paid.html> (reporting that, between 2009-2014, New York City paid out more nearly \$500 million to settle NYPD-related cases); see also City of New York, Office of the Comptroller Claims Report FY 2012, 30, June 4, 2013, <https://www.documentcloud.org/documents/1375759-fy-2012-claims-report.html> (noting that, in fiscal year 2012, so-called “police action claims,” which are claims that result from false arrest or imprisonment, police shootings, excessive use of force, assault, or failure to protect, cost the City \$64.4 million, and that in fiscal year 2011, the City paid out \$60.2 million in police action claims).

gleaned from civil rights lawsuits that could improve training, leadership, supervision, and discipline in the NYPD. Although certain police officers, units, and precincts have been found to have violated New Yorkers' constitutional rights *repeatedly*, the City refuses to track the data, or even to use the data it already has.⁵

47. Courts – including this nation's highest court – assume that civil rights lawsuits deter police misconduct. *See Wyatt v. Cole*, 504 U.S. 158, 161 (1992) (“The purpose of § 1983 is to deter state actors from using the badge of their authority to deprive individuals of their federally guaranteed rights and to provide relief to victims if such deterrence fails.”) (citing *Carey v. Phipps*, 435 U.S. 247, 254-257 (1978)); *Hudson v. Michigan*, 547 U.S. 586, 598 (2006) (“As far as we know, civil liability is an effective deterrent [to civil rights violations], as we have assumed it is in other contexts.”) (citing *Corr. Servs. Corp. v. Malesko*, 534 U.S. 61, 70 (2001) and *Nix v. Williams*, 467 U.S. 431, 446, (1984)).

48. However, because the City of New York refuses to track civil rights lawsuits, such suits do not serve the deterrent purpose envisioned by the Supreme Court.

49. Civil rights lawsuits against NYPD officers have no impact on the officers' careers, regardless of the expense to the City to defend a police misconduct case, and even when the same officers are named in multiple lawsuits, because settlements of civil claims are ordinarily not even noted in an officer's personnel file.⁶

50. By failing to keep track of crucial data – which could save lives as well as taxpayer

⁵ *See, e.g.*, Barry Paddock, et al., *Exclusive: Detective is NYPD's most-sued cop, with 28 lawsuits filed against him since 2006*, N.Y. DAILY NEWS, Feb. 16, 2014, <http://www.nydailynews.com/new-york/lawsuits-nypd-double-decade-costing-taxpayers-1b-article-1.1615919#ixzz2ttDX4ZkE> (“The [Daily] News' investigation was centered around the results of a Freedom of Information Law request for a list of lawsuits filed against officers who have been sued 10 or more times over the past decade. The city Law Department provided the names of 51 officers and 463 cases. A News search found an additional 146 cases against the officers, and four other officers who should have been included in the response — calling into question the city's ability to track these cases.”).

⁶ Association of the Bar of the City of New York, Committee on New York City Affairs, “The Failure of Civil Damages Claims to Modify Police Practices, and Recommendations for Change,” March 2000, *available at* http://www2.nycbar.org/Publications/reports/print_report.php?rid=32.

money – the City has created a system in which lawsuits are severed from any potential deterrent effect.

THE CITY FAILS TO DISCIPLINE OFFICERS WHO COMMIT PERJURY AND FALSIFY OFFICIAL RECORDS

51. The City is liable to Plaintiff for its failure to keep track of judicial decisions in suppression hearings where police officers have been found to have fabricated testimony.

52. There are hundreds of published decisions from the past several years in which judges in New York City courtrooms determine that, as a matter of law, police officers have testified incredibly, conducted illegal searches and seizures, and even suborned perjury.

53. Judicial decisions from suppression hearings and trials are particularly reliable indicators of a police officer's professional conduct and credibility because the testimony has been tested in open court, under oath.

54. Yet those in a position of authority – such as NYPD supervisors and prosecutors – have no procedure to notify individual officers or their supervisors of adverse judicial findings.

55. Without any notification, improper search and seizure practices and incredible testimony go uncorrected, problematic supervision or leadership at the precinct level goes ignored, and repeated misconduct by individual officers goes unaccounted for.

56. This has created a climate where police officers and detectives lie to prosecutors and in police paperwork and charging instruments, and testify falsely, with no fear of reprisal. As the Honorable Jack Weinstein, United States District Court Judge of the Eastern District of New York, has written:

Informal inquiry by the court and among the judges of this court, as well as knowledge of cases in other federal and state courts, has revealed anecdotal evidence of repeated, widespread falsification by arresting police officers of the New York City Police Department. Despite numerous inquiries by commissions and

strong reported efforts by the present administration—through selection of candidates for the police force stressing academic and other qualifications, serious training to avoid constitutional violations, and strong disciplinary action within the department—there is some evidence of an attitude among officers that is sufficiently widespread to constitute a custom or policy by the city approving illegal conduct of the kind now charged.

Colon v. City of New York, No. 09-CV-8, 2009 WL 4263362, at *2 (E.D.N.Y. Nov. 25, 2009).

THE CITY FAILS TO HOLD POLICE OFFICERS FINANCIALLY LIABLE, RESULTING IN A COMPLETE LACK OF ACCOUNTABILITY

57. The City of New York is also liable in this case because, by habitually indemnifying police officers who have acted unconstitutionally, the City isolates such officers from accountability.⁷ The effect – yet again – is that civil rights lawsuits do not serve a deterrent purpose. “It is almost axiomatic that the threat of damages has a deterrent effect, *surely particularly so when the individual official faces personal financial liability.*” *Carlson v. Green*, 446 U.S. 14, 21, (1980) [emphasis added] (citing *Imbler v. Pachtman*, 424 U.S. 409, 442 (1976)) [footnote omitted].

THE CITY HAS FAILED TO CREATE A MEANINGFUL POLICE OVERSIGHT AGENCY, THUS ALLOWING OFFICERS’ UNLAWFUL BEHAVIOR TO GO UNCHECKED

58. The City is liable because it has created a legal system in which officer misconduct routinely goes unpunished.

59. The City has purported to attempt to address police officers’ abuse of authority, in part through the creation of the CCRB, a police oversight agency with investigative powers.

60. However, the CCRB has proved vastly inadequate.

⁷ See Eric Jaffe, *When Cops Violate Civil Rights, It’s City Taxpayers Who Pay*, CITYLAB, Dec. 4, 2014, <http://www.citylab.com/crime/2014/12/when-cops-violate-civil-rights-its-city-taxpayers-who-pay/383419/> (reporting that taxpayers almost always satisfy both compensatory and punitive damages awards entered against police officers).

61. First, the CCRB fails in its mission because it often has found that complainants “lack credibility” based on the fact that the complainant has also brought a civil rights lawsuit. The result is that the CCRB often fails to substantiate some of the most serious allegations.

62. Second, when the CCRB has determined that officers have made false statements to the CCRB in their own defense, the CCRB virtually never initiates its own findings against those dishonest officers. The same is true in situations where the CCRB finds that officers have failed to report their fellow officers’ misconduct.

63. Third, because the CCRB’s penalty recommendations are purely advisory and there is no enforcement mechanism, the recommendations have no binding effect on the NYPD or its officers. Even when the CCRB substantiates complaints, the police department rarely imparts its own discipline on the officer, and often simply drops the complaints.⁸

64. Fourth, the NYPD Department Advocate, which is endowed with the responsibility of following up on substantiated CCRB charges, is understaffed and under-utilized. Furthermore, in the rare event that the CCRB substantiates a complaint and the Department Advocate proves the case in an internal trial against an officer, the police commissioner still maintains the power to reduce the discipline against such an officer, a power the commissioner has wielded.

65. The complaint procedure provides seemingly countless opportunities for City agencies to dismiss or disregard legitimate, credible complaints.

66. Due to the failures of the CCRB, many abuses of authority by police officers go unreported. Officers are thus free to abuse their authority with little or no fear of repercussions.

⁸ See Nathan Tempey, *CCRB: Cop Who Shoved Kid Through Hookah Bar Window Used Excessive Force*, gothamist, July 28, 2015, http://gothamist.com/2015/07/28/bronx_hookah_window_ccrb.php (reporting that in 2014, the CCRB substantiated only 327 of nearly 5,000 complaints, and that the NYPD disciplined 102 officers in that same period. Of the officers disciplined, only 22 faced administrative charges); WNYC.org, *Police Punishment: CCRB vs NYPD*, <http://project.wnyc.org/ccrb/> (last visited July 23, 2015) (reporting that, in 2012, police officers received no discipline in 104 cases (40.3%) of the substantiated complaints processed (258); in 2013, the NYPD dropped 28.3% of the substantiated complaints without any disciplinary action; in 2014, it dropped 24.5%).

Here, the lack of accountability contributed to the defendant police officers' actions described above in that the officer defendants knew they were insulated from any repercussions for their unlawful actions against Plaintiff.

THE CITY HAS ENCOURAGED UNCONSTITUTIONAL STOPS THROUGH ITS USE OF ARREST QUOTAS

67. The City has also been alerted to the regular use of “Stop, Question, and Frisk” by its police officers, which disproportionately target people of color, despite the humiliation, inconvenience, and constitutional violations that the majority of law-abiding people, mostly in communities of color, suffer as a result.

68. Even as the use of “Stop, Question, and Frisk” has declined precipitously in recent years – in large part due to the federal class action lawsuit *Floyd, et al. v. City of New York, et al.*, 08-CV-1034 (SAS) – the police have continued to use the policing tactic in a severely racially disproportionate manner, and for the improper purpose of meeting “performance goals” (more commonly known as arrest quotas).

69. According to data collected by the New York Civil Liberties Union (“NYCLU”), in 2014, New Yorkers were stopped by the police 46,235 times. Of the people stopped: 38,051 were totally innocent of any crime (82%); 24,777 were Black (55%); 12,662 were Latino (29%); and 5,536 were white (12%).⁹

70. The City is also aware that the misconduct does not stop at the regular use of stop and frisks to violate the civil rights of innocent people. For example, the NYCLU reported that more than 85% of summonses for Open Container were given to Black and Latino New Yorkers,

⁹ See NYCLU, *Stop and Frisk Campaign: About the Issue*, <http://www.nyclu.org/content/stop-and-frisk-data> (last visited July 22, 2015).

whereas white recipients made up merely 4%.¹⁰ The grossly disproportionate issuance of summonses to New Yorkers of color led one Kings County judge to note that he could not recall ever having arraigned a white defendant on an Open Container charge.¹¹

71. Police officers have repeatedly told New York City news investigations that their supervisors pressure them into reaching “performance goals,” resulting in the violation of innocent New Yorker’s civil rights.¹²

72. The City’s inability to prevent its officers from abusing the stop and frisk policy is emblematic of the City’s continuing failures to exercise adequate control over the NYPD, and to prevent police officers from abusing their authority. Such failures have led to further abuse of authority by police officers, including the incident underlying Plaintiff’s Complaint.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
FALSE ARREST & FALSE IMPRISONMENT

73. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference.

74. Defendants subjected Plaintiff to false arrest, false imprisonment, and deprivation of liberty without probable cause.

75. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff, Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement, and did not consent to his confinement.

76. Defendants, their officers, agents, servants and employees, were responsible for Plaintiff’s arrest, detention, and imprisonment during this period of time.

¹⁰ See NYCLU, *Testimony Before City Council Public Safety & Courts and Legal Services Committees On Summons Court Operations and Impact*, <http://www.nyclu.org/content/testimony-city-council-public-safety-courts-and-legal-services-committees-summons-court-oper>.

¹¹ *People v. Figueroa*, 36 Misc.3d 605, 608 (Kings Co. 2012).

¹² See Jim Hoffer, *NYPD Officer Claims Pressure to Make Arrests*, WABC News (Mar. 2, 2010, 10:37 PM), <http://7online.com/archive/7305356/> and Jim Hoffer, *Kelly Responds to Our NYPD Quotas*, WABC News (May 25, 2010, 3:31 PM), <http://7online.com/archive/7461355/>.

77. As a direct and proximate result of the misconduct and the abuse of authority detailed above, Plaintiff sustained the damages described above.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION
MALICIOUS PROSECUTION

78. The preceding paragraphs are here incorporated by reference.

79. Defendants, acting with malice, initiated a prosecution against Plaintiff and caused him to be prosecuted.

80. Defendants did not have probable cause to initiate criminal proceedings.

81. The proceedings were terminated in Plaintiff's favor on August 18, 2015, when the summons was dismissed and sealed.

82. Defendants have deprived Plaintiff of his civil, constitutional, and statutory rights and have conspired to deprive him of such rights. They are liable to Plaintiff under 42 U.S.C. § 1983, New York State common law, and the New York State Constitution.

83. As a result of the malicious prosecution implemented by defendants, Plaintiff was damaged.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION
NEGLIGENT HIRING & RETENTION

84. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference.

85. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.

86. Defendant City, through the NYPD, breached its duty of care to Plaintiff because under the same or similar circumstances a reasonable, prudent and careful person should have known there was no U.S. Marshals warrant for Plaintiff and should have anticipated an injury to Plaintiff or those in a position similar to Plaintiff as a result of this conduct.

87. Defendant officers were incompetent and unfit for their positions.

88. Defendant City knew or should have known through exercise of reasonable diligence that the officer defendants were potentially dangerous and had previously falsely arrested civilians without probable cause.

89. Defendant City's negligence in hiring and retaining the officer defendants proximately caused Plaintiff's injuries.

90. Because of the defendant City's negligent hiring and retention of defendant officers, Plaintiff incurred damages described above.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
RESPONDEAT SUPERIOR

91. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference.

92. Defendants' tortious acts were undertaken within the scope of their employment by defendant City of New York and in furtherance of the defendant City of New York's interest.

93. As a result of Defendants' tortious conduct in the course of their employment and in furtherance of the business of defendant City of New York, Plaintiff was damaged.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against the defendants, jointly and severally, as follows:

A. In favor of Plaintiff in an amount to be determined by a jury for each of Plaintiff's causes of action;

B. Awarding Plaintiff punitive damages in an amount to be determined by a jury;

C. Awarding Plaintiff reasonable attorneys' fees, costs and disbursements of this action; and

D. Granting such other and further relief as this Court deems just and proper.

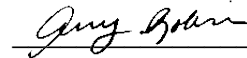
JURY DEMAND

Plaintiff demands a trial by jury.

DATED: November 24, 2015
Brooklyn, New York

Respectfully yours,

STOLL, GLICKMAN & BELLINA, LLP



Amy E. Robinson, Esq.
475 Atlantic Avenue, 3rd Floor
Brooklyn, NY 11217
(718) 852-3710
(718) 852-3586
arobinson@stollglickman.com

TO: City of New York
100 Church Street
New York, NY 10007

Officer Marcello Solano #7497
44th Precinct
2 East 169th Street
Bronx, NY 10452

Attorneys for Plaintiff